

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2019

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: **THREE** hours

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

The paper consists of **SEVENTEEN** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

Candidates are permitted to bring into the examination room, and consult, hardcopy English Language dictionaries. Subject dictionaries are not allowed.

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator. Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room. Do not open the question paper until told to do so. All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided. All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked. At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION A

1. How have empiricism and positivism influenced sociology? How important are these ideas for sociology today?
2. How have the ideas of neo-Kantians influenced sociology? How important are these ideas for sociology today?
3. Is modernity a colonial project?
4. Using the work of at least two writers, critically examine how sociologists have used analyses of language to understand social relations.
5. Critically assess Barthes' argument that the signs used in popular culture are ideological.
6. What is distinctive about Bourdieu's theory of class inequality? How useful is his argument?
7. Critically discuss why sociologists need to engage in analyses of the global distribution of wealth and/or income.
8. Is it possible for feminism to analyse the experience of all women as a single group?
9. What do feminists mean by "standpoint"? How useful is this term for thinking about the relations between gender and knowledge?

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION B

10. Outline and assess Foucault's challenge to traditional sociological approaches to power.
11. What does Foucault mean by "biopower"? How useful is this term for analysing contemporary society?
12. What does Du Bois mean by the term "double consciousness"? How useful is this term of analysing contemporary society?
13. Drawing on the work of at least two theorists, critically discuss the key concepts of post-colonial theory.
14. Critically explain Haraway's statement that 'How we see the world is always a matter of power'.
15. How have sociologists theorised the material body? How successful have they been in this?
16. How have sociologists have attempted to theorise sexual difference. Why is this topic important today?
17. 'One of the most vital tasks for contemporary sociology is to develop ways of analysing the status of animals in society.' Assess this statement.

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER